Pradesh to supervise the building of his house on the day of the decision. One news article described him as the 'the picture of relaxation' on the day.[27] His lawyer Tulsi also warned that it was still somewhat early for Bajaj to celebrate victory. This confidence may have flowed from the continuing unwillingness of witnesses to come forward and corroborate Bajaj's account. The best corroborating witness from that evening, Mrs Bijlani, observed, 'There is no question of going to court as witnesses. At the time [when the incident occurred] we gave a statement to the police without thinking. We refused to go to court then and even now, we will not [go].'[28] Public opinion and the press remained firmly in Gill's camp. In her weekly column for the *Indian Express*, journalist Tavleen Singh criticized Bajaj for wasting the Supreme Court's time. In an interview shortly thereafter, she described it as 'quite obscene' that this case could be taken to the highest court of the land, when women in the villages confronted far more pressing concerns.[29]

Given the long delay before the trial could commence, the Supreme Court directed the magistrate to endeavour to conclude the trial within six months. The trial ultimately overshot this time frame by a small margin. Tuesday, 6 August 1996 was D-Day. By now, the Kapur party was faint in the memory – nearly eight years had passed since then. Mrs Bajaj could not bear to be personally present in court when the decision was pronounced. Gill was then president of the Indian Hockey Federation and had retired from the police. His supporters were so confident of his impending victory that, as Bajaj later revealed in an interview to the BBC, the police band was ready outside the court to celebrate his acquittal.[30] Since the state was prosecuting Gill, this yielded the curious result that the police band was standing ready to celebrate the failure of the state prosecution.

Chief Judicial Magistrate Darshan Singh announced that Gill was convicted on both counts. He was sentenced to three months' rigorous imprisonment for 'outraging the modesty' of a woman, and two months' rigorous imprisonment for engaging in speech and gestures intended to 'insult the modesty' of a woman. As the sentences would run concurrently, Gill faced the prospect of spending three months in prison unless he succeeded on appeal. The chief judicial magistrate also imposed fines in the